

Submitting cureAssess 0.1.0 to CRAN

A step-by-step guide for the package maintainer

Prepared for Geethanjalee Mudunkotuwa

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1 Before anything else: read this page

You are listed in the package as the **maintainer** (cre). CRAN requires that the person who submits a package *is* its maintainer, because:

- the email address you type into the submission form must match the maintainer address in the DESCRIPTION file, character for character; and
- CRAN emails a confirmation link to that address, and **the submission does not exist until that link is clicked**.

Your maintainer address is:

geethanjaleem@gmail.com

Everything in this guide assumes you are working from that mailbox.

1.1 Who does what

Step	Who
1. Review the two items in Section 2	You
2. Send you the package source or tarball	Durbadal
3. Set up R, pandoc and LaTeX (Section 4)	You
4. Build and check locally (Section 6)	You
5. Run the win-builder checks (Section 7)	You
6. Submit the web form (Section 8)	You
7. Click the confirmation email (Section 9)	You only

1.2 Current state of the package

The package has been prepared for submission and currently passes CRAN's own check cleanly:

Check	Result
R CMD check --as-cran	0 errors, 0 warnings, 2 notes
Note 1	"New submission" – expected and unavoidable
Note 2	Local HTML Tidy version – will not occur on CRAN
Test suite	40 of 40 pass

Check	Result
PDF manual	Builds cleanly
Vignette	Builds cleanly

2 Two things to review before you submit

These are decisions made on your behalf during preparation. Please confirm both before submitting, because your name goes on the result.

2.1 A corrected reference in `qn.test()` – please verify

The documentation for `qn.test()` originally cited:

Maller RA, et al. (2024).

The `qn` test for the cure proportion.

Stat Med, 2024;43(8):1557–75.

This paper could not be found. It does not resolve in Crossref or PubMed: there is no article with that title, and *Statistics in Medicine* volume 43, issue 8, pages 1557–75 is a different paper entirely.

It has been replaced with what appears to be the intended source – the paper that derives finite-sample critical values for the q_n statistic:

Maller RA, Resnick S, Shemehsavar S (2024).

Finite sample and asymptotic distributions of a statistic for sufficient follow-up in cure models.

Canadian Journal of Statistics, 52(2), 359–379.

doi:10.1002/cjs.11771

Please confirm this is the reference you meant. If you had a different paper in mind, tell Durbadal and it will be corrected before submission. CRAN resolves DOIs automatically during its incoming checks, so an unverifiable citation is likely to be queried.

2.2 Authorship and maintainership

The DESCRIPTION file now reads:

Person	Roles
Geethanjalee Mudunkotuwa	aut, cre, cph – author, maintainer, copyright holder
Durbadal Ghosh	aut – author

The LICENSE file continues to name you as copyright holder. If you would prefer a different arrangement, change it *before* submitting – altering the maintainer after acceptance requires a separate email to CRAN.

What being maintainer commits you to: CRAN will email you whenever your package breaks against a new R release or a changed dependency. You are expected to respond, usually within two weeks. Packages whose maintainers do not respond are archived and removed from CRAN.

3 What has already been done

You do not need to redo any of this. It is listed so you know what changed since you last worked on the package.

Area	What was done
DESCRIPTION	Added method references with DOIs (CRAN requires these); added URL, BugReports, Language: en-US
qn.test()	Corrected the unverifiable citation – see Section 2.1
References	Attached verified DOIs to all six citations
Examples	Added runnable examples to five exported functions that had none
?cureAssess	Added package-level help page
Encoding	Replaced seven non-ASCII en-dashes with ASCII equivalents
README	Replaced the unedited devtools template with real content
Vignette	Fixed 20 malformed headings, two typos, a mislabelled code block, and a variable that shadowed <code>survival::gbsg</code>
cran-comments.md	Written, ready to paste into the submission form

The statistical behaviour of the package was not changed. Only three lines of executable code differ from your original, all of them text labels that get printed rather than computed with. This was verified by installing your original version alongside the current one and confirming every numeric result is identical to the last digit.

4 Setting up your machine

Skip any step you have already done.

4.1 R version 4.1.0 or newer

The package declares `Depends: R (>= 4.1.0)`. Check your version:

```
R.version.string
```

If it is older, install a current R from <https://cran.r-project.org>.

4.2 Package dependencies

In R, run:

```
install.packages(c(
  "survival", "flexsurv", "flexsurvcure", "survminer",
  "ggplot2", "dplyr",
```

```
"knitr", "rmarkdown", "testthat",  
"devtools", "roxygen2", "rcmdcheck"  
)
```

4.3 pandoc – required to build the vignette

Without pandoc, R CMD build fails with *“Pandoc is required to build R Markdown vignettes”*.

If you have **RStudio** installed, it ships a copy and RStudio finds it automatically – **run every command in this guide from inside RStudio’s console** and you can skip this step.

If you work from a terminal instead, install pandoc from <https://pandoc.org/installing.html>, then confirm:

```
rmarkdown::pandoc_available() # must return TRUE
```

4.4 LaTeX – required to build the PDF manual

CRAN builds a PDF reference manual, so your local check needs LaTeX too. If you do not already have a TeX installation:

```
install.packages("tinytex")  
tinytex::install_tinytex()
```

That downloads roughly 250 MB and takes a few minutes. Confirm afterwards:

```
tinytex::is_tinytex() # must return TRUE
```

5 Getting the package source

Durbadal has the prepared version. The changes are on a git branch called `cran-submission-prep`. Ask him for **either**:

Option A – the built tarball (simplest). A single file named `cureAssess_0.1.0.tar.gz`. Put it in a folder of your choice. You can submit this file directly, though you should still run the checks in Sections 6 and 7.

Option B – the source repository (preferred). He pushes the branch to GitHub, and you clone or pull it. This lets you inspect every change, rebuild from source, and keeps the history. In a terminal:

```
git clone https://github.com/GeethanjaleeM/cureAssess.git
cd cureAssess
git checkout cran-submission-prep
```

Option B is better if you want to review the changes described in Section 3 before putting your name to them.

6 Building and checking locally

Work in the folder that contains the DESCRIPTION file.

6.1 Build the tarball

From a terminal:

```
R CMD build .
```

This produces `cureAssess_0.1.0.tar.gz`. If you were given the tarball directly (Option A above), skip this.

6.2 Run the CRAN check

```
R CMD check --as-cran cureAssess_0.1.0.tar.gz
```

This takes a few minutes. Or, equivalently, from within R:

```
devtools::check()
```

6.3 Reading the result

The last line reports the status. **You are looking for:**

```
Status: 1 NOTE
```

or

```
Status: 2 NOTES
```

Either is fine, provided the notes are the two expected ones:

Expected note 1 – always present, cannot be removed:

```
* checking CRAN incoming feasibility ... NOTE
Maintainer: 'Geethanjalee Mudunkotuwa <geethanjaleem@gmail.com>'
```

New submission

This simply tells the reviewer the package is new. It is not a problem.

Expected note 2 – may or may not appear, depending on your system:

* checking HTML version of manual ... NOTE

Skipping checking HTML validation: 'tidy' doesn't look like recent enough HTML Tidy.

This is about the tidy program on your own computer, not about the package. CRAN's machines have a current version, so it will not appear there.

If you see any ERROR or WARNING, stop and tell Durbadal. Do not submit.

If you see a note that is not one of the two above, read it carefully – it usually names the exact file and line at fault.

7 Running the win-builder checks

CRAN expects a package to have been tested against the development version of R before submission. This is done through a free service called win-builder. **Do not skip this** – it is the single most common way a first submission gets bounced for something avoidable.

7.1 Submit to win-builder

From R, in the package folder:

```
devtools::check_win_devel()    # R-devel (the important one)
devtools::check_win_release()  # current R release
```

Each uploads your tarball to a Windows machine in Germany, which builds and checks it.

Note: this step could not be completed on Durbadal’s machine – his network blocks win-builder entirely. If the commands above hang or time out for you as well, try a different network (home instead of university Wi-Fi, or a phone hotspot).

7.2 Wait for the results

Results arrive by email at geethanjaleem@gmail.com, usually within 15 to 30 minutes but occasionally longer. **Check your spam folder.**

The email contains a link to a check log. Open it and look at the final **Status:** line. You want the same outcome as Section 6.3 – notes only, no errors or warnings.

A note you may see only on Windows:

```
* checking CRAN incoming feasibility ... NOTE
Possibly misspelled words in DESCRIPTION:
  Kaplan, Maller, Othus, RECeUS, Selukar, Shen, Zhou
```

These are author surnames and a method acronym. They are spelled correctly. The `cran-comments.md` file already explains this to the reviewer.

Wait for both emails and confirm both are clean before continuing.

8 Submitting to CRAN

Go to:

<https://cran.r-project.org/submit.html>

The form has four fields. Fill them in exactly as follows.

8.1 Your name

Geethanjalee Mudunkotuwa

8.2 Your email address

geethanjaleem@gmail.com

This **must** match the maintainer address in DESCRIPTION exactly. A mismatch causes automatic rejection.

8.3 The package file

Click *Browse* and select:

cureAssess_0.1.0.tar.gz

Make sure you upload the .tar.gz file itself – not a folder, and not a .zip.

8.4 Optional comments

Open the file cran-comments.md in the package folder and paste its contents into this box. It tells the reviewer:

- which platforms you tested on;
- that the “New submission” note is expected;
- that the flagged words are surnames, not misspellings;
- that the package writes nothing outside tempdir() and has no compiled code.

Then click **Upload package**.

9 Confirming by email – do not miss this

Within a few minutes, CRAN sends an email to geethanjaleem@gmail.com with a subject line like “CRAN submission cureAssess 0.1.0”. It contains a confirmation link.

You must click that link. Until you do, your package has not been submitted – it sits in limbo and is eventually discarded. This is the single most common way a first submission silently fails.

Check your spam folder if it has not arrived within about ten minutes.

10 What happens next

After you confirm, the package enters CRAN's queue. Automated checks run first, then a human volunteer reviews it. A first submission typically takes between one day and two weeks.

There are three possible outcomes.

10.1 Accepted

You receive an email saying the package has been published. It appears at <https://cran.r-project.org/package=cureAssess> within a day, and becomes installable by anyone:

```
install.packages("cureAssess")
```

10.2 Changes requested – this is normal

Most first submissions get at least one round of comments. **This is not a rejection.** A reviewer will ask for something specific, for example:

- wording in the Description field;
- an example that should not be wrapped in `\dont run{}`;
- a missing `\value{}` section in a help file.

To respond:

1. Make the change.
2. Bump the version in DESCRIPTION to 0.1.1.
3. Add a line to cran-comments.md saying what you changed.
4. Re-run Sections 6 and 7.
5. Resubmit through the same web form.

Reply in the same email thread. Do not start an unrelated new submission.

10.3 Rejected outright

Unlikely at this stage, since the check is already clean. If it happens, the email will explain why.

11 After acceptance

Ask Durbadal to tag the release in git so the exact submitted source is recorded:

```
git tag -a v0.1.0 -m "CRAN release 0.1.0"
```

From then on, remember the maintainer obligation described in Section 2.2: watch for emails from CRAN about your package, and respond promptly.

A Quick reference

Submission URL – <https://cran.r-project.org/submit.html>

Form field	Value
Name	Geethanjalee Mudunkotuwa
Email	geethanjaleem@gmail.com
File	cureAssess_0.1.0.tar.gz
Comments	contents of cran-comments.md

The whole sequence in commands:

1. build and check locally

```
devtools::check()
```

2. check on R-devel and release (wait for both emails)

```
devtools::check_win_devel()
```

```
devtools::check_win_release()
```

3. then submit at <https://cran.r-project.org/submit.html>

4. then CLICK THE CONFIRMATION EMAIL

B Troubleshooting

“Pandoc is required to build R Markdown vignettes” Pandoc is missing or not on your PATH.

Run the commands from inside RStudio, which bundles its own copy. See Section 4.3.

“pdflatex is not available” LaTeX is missing. Install TinyTeX – see Section 4.4. Until you do, the check reports a spurious error and warning about the PDF manual that has nothing to do with the package.

check_win_devel() hangs or times out Your network is blocking win-builder. Try a different network or a phone hotspot. This happened on Durbadal’s machine.

“there is no package called ‘cureAssess’” Something tried to load the package before it was installed. Run `devtools::install()` first, or use `devtools::check()` which handles this.

The confirmation email never arrives Check spam. Confirm the email you typed into the form matches `geethanjaleem@gmail.com` exactly. If it still does not arrive after an hour, resubmit.

A check flags a “possibly invalid DOI” All six DOIs in the package were verified against Crossref and resolve correctly. Some publishers (Oxford, Taylor and Francis, Wiley) return an error to automated checkers while working fine in a browser. Say so in your reply to the reviewer.

C Optional improvements, not required for CRAN

Two rough edges were deliberately left alone, because fixing them would change how the package behaves and that was your decision to make. Neither blocks submission.

final_recommendation ignores the Stage 2 diagnostics. For the `gbsg` data, RECeUS returns “*Follow-up insufficient for cure modeling*”, yet `final_recommendation` still reads “*provides initial support for cure model appropriateness*” and merely notes that diagnostics were run. The field summarises the

AIC screening step only. A statistically-minded reviewer may raise this, since it works against the package's own two-stage argument.

run.cure.tests() has no print method. It returns an object of class "cure.tests", but printing it dumps the raw nested list. The vignette avoids this by printing each component separately.